DREW K. KENNEDY

Senior Software Engineer, Applied AI • Game Developer • Content Creator

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SUMMARY

Applied AI engineer who builds AI systems a whole company uses every day, end to end: architecture, model and data integration, evaluation, deployment, and the operations work that keeps them trustworthy. At Pocket Worlds (Highrise, a mobile social MMO), designed and solely built a company-wide agentic assistant and an in-house generative art suite. 13+ years shipping Unity/C# games; creator of the Nintendrew YouTube channel (350,000+ subscribers).

EXPERIENCE

Pocket Worlds — Senior Software Engineer II, Applied AI

Jan 2025 – Present

Sole architect, developer and operator of the company's two main internal AI platforms, and of the agentic engineering practice behind them.

- **Company AI assistant:** agentic, source-grounded assistant used across LiveOps, support, data, art and leadership. 140+ tools over the data warehouse, Slack, Notion, GitHub, project tracking, support tickets, Discord, Figma and the game's admin systems; cited answers; human approval on every product write; per-user data isolation. Runs scheduled briefs, a weekly company digest, daily live-event health checks and a support mode, and serves other agents through MCP and a REST API. Python, FastAPI, Postgres, Claude on AWS Bedrock, 1,300+ automated tests.
- **Generative art suite:** in-house replacement for a third-party AI art vendor. Trained custom image-edit LoRAs on curated in-house datasets and ran blind side-by-side evaluations with the art team as judges: the suite won the final round 65/35 and 4 of 5 production tools. 40+ users, 2,000+ generations a week. React/TypeScript, FastAPI, multiple image model providers, plus an MCP server and API so other agents can generate on-style art.
- **Internal tools:** built a self-serve app builder on Anthropic's Managed Agents that lets non-engineers describe an admin panel tool in plain language and get it built, tested against recorded data and deployed. Hand-built React micro-apps that automate LiveOps work such as monthly creator compensation and event release preflight checks.
- **Agent R&D:** built an autonomous loop that scouts trends, then builds, tests and publishes game worlds (it shipped its first worlds to the live game), and a Unity agent that reproduces client bugs and opens draft PRs with before/after proof.
- **Games:** led engineering for weekly live-service events (Unity/C#) and built an in-game platform for host-run live Bingo and Trivia. Mentored the Worlds team and set its AI-assisted development practice.

Independent — Game Developer

2020 – 2025

- Co-created and shipped C.A.R.L., a 2D puzzle-platformer, to Steam, Nintendo Switch, Xbox and PlayStation as a two-person team: core gameplay, UI, optimization and cross-platform builds (Unity/C#), plus dialogue, soundtrack and pixel art.

Nintendrew — Content Creator

2016 – Present

- Built a YouTube channel on video game history and preservation to 350,000+ subscribers as a solo production: writing, filming, editing and scoring. Recurring convention guest, host and panelist.

Augterra — Senior Unity Developer

2016 – 2017

- Owned code base and build management; developed rapid prototypes for Karobi, an unreleased AR card battle game.

NC2 Media — Game Engineer, C#/Unity

2015 – 2017

- Built and iterated on multiple simultaneously-developed Unity titles for an unannounced R&D project.

Hitcents — Game Developer → Lead Game Developer

2013 – 2015

- Core gameplay engineering, then small-team leadership, on Draw a Stickman: EPIC 1 & 2 and Battlepillars — C# with XNA/Unity, shipped to Windows, macOS, Linux, iOS, Android and Windows Phone.

EDUCATION

Western Kentucky University — B.S. Computer Science, Cum Laude

2009 – 2013

- Minor in Computer Information Systems • WKU Game Research Group • The Gatton Academy of Mathematics and Science (Newsweek #1 high school in the nation), later returning as CS tutor.

SKILLS

AI & backend: Python, FastAPI, Postgres, TypeScript/React, LLM agents and tool use, MCP, AWS Bedrock, Anthropic and OpenAI APIs, LoRA fine-tuning for image models, evaluation design, agentic development workflows

Games: C#, Unity, Unreal/UEFN, Lua, XNA, gameplay systems, live ops, cross-platform shipping

Production: game design, video production, music production & composition, voiceover, public speaking & live hosting